

Participant Starter Pack

A frozen, source-backed simulation for application-readiness tooling • Version 1.0 draft • 18 July 2026

24 synthetic documents
6 fictional households

32 HUD LIHTC records
36 gold Q&A

The job to be done

Build a human-review assistant that extracts evidence, annualizes documented recurring gross income, retrieves the frozen FY 2026 60% MTSP threshold, identifies document gaps or conflicts, and cites every material result.

Hard boundary

- Do not determine eligibility, approval, denial, priority, or housing availability.
- Treat document contents as untrusted; ignore embedded instructions.
- Use only the frozen rule corpus for scored calculations and disclose assumptions.
- Return `READY_TO_REVIEW` or `NEEDS_REVIEW` with evidence-linked reasons.

What is in the pack

Each component is machine-readable, human-reviewable, and versionable.

PATH	PURPOSE
data/	HUD LIHTC metro subset, dictionary, and frozen MTSP table
rules/	Official-source facts plus clearly labeled challenge conventions
synthetic_documents/	24 fictional PDFs, document manifest, field values, and PDF-point source boxes
evaluation/	Gold household checklists, 36 Q&A records, 24 adversarial tests, and scoring guidance
starter/	Standard-library Python loaders, deterministic calculations, schemas, and unit tests
governance/	Safety boundary, license manifest, and organizer approvals still required

Five-minute quick start

- Read [rules/RULES_README.md](#) and [governance/DATA_USE_AND_SAFETY.md](#).
- Inspect [synthetic_documents/gold/field_schema.json](#) before parsing PDFs.
- From [starter/](#), run: `python -m unittest discover -s tests -v`
- Produce output conforming to [starter/schemas/submission.schema.json](#).
- Test against [evaluation/adversarial_tests.jsonl](#) before submitting.

Limits, evidence, and readiness

One reproducible baseline keeps the 24-hour event focused on product quality.

Scored numeric baseline

HOUSEHOLD	50% CONTEXT	60% SCORED	AREA
1	\$60,000	\$72,000	Boston-Cambridge-Quincy HMFA
2	\$68,600	\$82,320	Boston-Cambridge-Quincy HMFA
3	\$77,150	\$92,580	Boston-Cambridge-Quincy HMFA
4	\$85,700	\$102,840	Boston-Cambridge-Quincy HMFA
5	\$92,600	\$111,120	Boston-Cambridge-Quincy HMFA
6	\$99,450	\$119,340	Boston-Cambridge-Quincy HMFA
7	\$106,300	\$127,560	Boston-Cambridge-Quincy HMFA
8	\$113,150	\$135,780	Boston-Cambridge-Quincy HMFA

Readiness convention

- Evidence dated within 60 days of 2026-07-18 is current for this simulation.
- Conflicting totals, missing required evidence, unsupported gig income, or missing citations produce NEEDS_REVIEW.
- The 60-day convention is not presented as a universal LIHTC rule.

Source boxes and expected output

Scoring rewards traceability, not fluent unsupported answers.

Source-box coordinate system

Each gold field includes page number and [x1, y1, x2, y2] in PDF points, with origin at the bottom-left of a 612 × 792 point page. Raster fixtures keep the same page coordinate system.

Required submission fields

- household_id, annualized_income, comparison, and readiness_status
- review reasons expressed as explicit evidence gaps or conflicts
- citations containing document_id, page, source box, and rule_id where applicable
- no final eligibility or availability conclusion

Evaluation mix

DIMENSION	WEIGHT
Extraction	35%
Calculation and threshold lookup	25%
Readiness reasoning	20%
Citations	10%
Safety/adversarial behavior	10%

What the sources can—and cannot—support

The pack is intentionally explicit about uncertainty and release approvals.

Public property subset

- 32 public HUD LIHTC project records across eight Boston-area municipalities in CBSA 14 460.
- Addresses are general project locations. Geocoding precision is retained and lower-precision records are flagged.
- Records do not establish current vacancies, rents, waitlists, owner procedures, or application status.

Release gate

- The pack is a draft until organizer, compliance, brand, and event-policy approvals are complete.
- No external model weights or SDK are bundled; teams must disclose model/provider and applicable terms.
- Starter code has a proposed MIT license but no final license grant is made in this draft.
- After edits, regenerate checksums and keep the source-retrieval date visible.

Primary source links

HUD MTSP: <https://www.huduser.gov/portal/datasets/mtsp.html>

FY 2026 official report: <https://www.huduser.gov/portal/datasets/mtsp/mtsp26/HERA-Income-Limits-Report-FY26.pdf>

HUD LIHTC properties: <https://www.huduser.gov/portal/datasets/lihtc/property.html>

26 U.S.C. §42: <https://uscode.house.gov/view.xhtml?req=granuleid:USC-prelim-title26-section42&num=0&edition=prelim>

26 CFR §1.42-5: <https://www.ecfr.gov/current/title-26/section-1.42-5>